

English Ladder

Teaching Guide

"Almost" vs. "Most"

A concise classroom guide with lesson flow, teaching cues, and a ready-to-use answer key built around the same English Ladder concept sheet.



Grammar Concepts #37

Key Points

Visual anchor

Use the concept poster to spotlight the main language pattern in "**Almost**" vs. "**Most**" and keep the explanation visible during practice and discussion.

ENGLISH LADDER

Concept #37 ▶ **Almost** vs **Most**

The word "**Almost**" points to a quantity or degree. For example, you can say the following to indicate your project is close to finished.

- The project is **almost** finished.

This means the project is, perhaps, 95% finished. However, the following sentence has **no meaning**:

- **Almost** dogs chase cats.

The word "almost" must point to a quantity when used before a noun as seen in the following sentences:

- **Almost** all dogs chase cats.
- **Almost** every dog chases cats.
- **Almost** no dogs chase cats.

The word "almost" can also be used with a verb to indicate how close to a threshold you are or were as in the following sentence:

- The dog **almost** caught the cat, but the cat ran a bit faster.

The word "**Most**" usually has the same meaning as "**almost all**".

- **Most** dogs chase cats. (95% of dogs)

In the case above, you are using the universal style, the style that refers to all dogs in the world. If you want to refer to a smaller subset of dogs, you need to use a different style such as the one shown below.

- **Most of the** dogs in Chicago chase cats.

Note that the universal style uses 2 words ("most dogs") while the subset style uses 4 words ("most of the dogs"), and usually a limiting phrase such as "in Chicago". The following sentence is **wrong**:

- **Most of dogs** chase cats.

The word "**most**" can also modify an adverb such as in the following sentence in which it means "**usually**".

- I **most often** eat lunch before noon.

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At a Glance

Lesson focus "Almost" vs. "Most"	Suggested timing 45-60 minutes
Core objective Students explain the target pattern clearly and apply it accurately in controlled practice and discussion.	Materials Student PDF, the concept image, board space, and time for partner checking.

Suggested Lesson Flow

Warm-up

Display the concept image and ask learners to predict the rule behind **"Almost" vs. "Most"** before reading the explanation.

Model

Walk through the Core Idea and the sections on Key Points. Pause after each part so students can restate the pattern in plain English.

Guided practice

Project two or three examples from the concept sheet and ask pairs to explain why each choice works, not just what the answer is.

Independent work

Assign the 24 practice items for quiet work, partner checking, and final feedback.

Closure

Ask students to create one new sentence or mini-example of their own that follows the same pattern.

Likely Learner Errors

- Learners may overgeneralize the first pattern they notice. Keep returning to **Key Points** and ask students to explain what changes from one example to the next.
- Long explanations can hide the signal word or structure. Have students underline the exact phrase that tells them which form, pattern, or response is needed.
- If students can choose an answer but cannot explain it, ask them to justify their choice using words taken directly from the concept sheet.

Differentiation and Delivery Notes



- Support: teach one section at a time, then send students back to **the examples** or the practice set so they can apply the same rule immediately.
- Pair work: let students compare answers aloud before you reveal the key. The explanation step is as important as the final answer.
- Extension: ask stronger students to write two fresh examples or a short dialogue that uses the same target language accurately.

Model Language from the Concept Sheet

- Examples: The cake is almost ready....
- Examples: Almost every student in the class passed the exam....
- Examples: The cat almost knocked over the vase....
- Incorrect: Almost dogs chase cats.
- Correct: Almost all dogs chase cats.
- Correct: Almost every dog chases cats.



Answer Key

Use this key for whole-class feedback or fast marking.

Item 01 See note.

Item 02 See note.

Item 03 See note.

Item 04 See note.

Item 05 See note.

Item 06 See note.

Item 07 See note.

Item 08 See note.

Item 09 See note.

Item 10 See note.

Item 11 See note.

Item 12 See note.

Item 13 See note.

Item 14 See note.

Item 15 See note.

Item 16 See note.

Item 17 See note.

Item 18 See note.

Item 19 See note.

Item 20 See note.

Item 21 See note.



Item 22 See note.

Item 23 See note.

Item 24 See note.

Feedback Cues

Item 01: Correct: a) almost Incorrect: b) most - "Most" cannot be used here because the sentence refers to something being nearly complete, which requires "almost".

Item 02: Correct: b) are Incorrect: a) is - "Most" refers to a plural subject, so the correct verb form is "are".

Item 03: Correct: b) almost Incorrect: a) most - "Most" is used for majority, while "almost" is used for nearly completing an action.

Item 04: Correct: b) Almost Incorrect: a) Most - "Most" would be incorrect because it would suggest the majority, not nearly all.

Item 05: Correct: a) almost Incorrect: b) most - "Most" is not used with "always" as it modifies adjectives and adverbs to mean usually or typically.

Item 06: Correct: a) Most Incorrect: b) Almost - "Almost" would suggest nearly everyone but doesn't accurately describe a general majority.